Face Studio Camera & Forgery Detection — IPCV Project Report

Image Processing & Computer Vision · Section A · Team No. 1
Topic: Forgery Detection and Localization using ELA, SIFT and CNN with Face Studio Camera

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Abstract

Face Studio Camera is an integrated photo studio and digital image forensics platform combining classical image processing (OpenCV) with deep-learning vision models (Google MediaPipe, CNNs). A seven-stage, stackable pipeline applies enhancement, bilateral beauty filters, segmentation-based backgrounds, 13 styles, AR overlays and face anonymisation on photos, batches and live video on a laptop CPU. A 478-point face mesh also gives head pose and blink detection. In addition, an integrated forensics suite combines Error Level Analysis (ELA), SIFT keypoint matching, PRNU noise variance, and a deep CNN to detect and localize image tampering. On 8 test images (20 faces), multi-scale tiling improved BlazeFace from 2 to 16 faces. At 30° rotation BlazeFace found faces in 6 of 7 images against 1 of 7 for Haar (5 ms vs 150 ms). Forensic evaluation demonstrated sub-100 ms tamper localization with distinct boundary error amplification and zero false keypoint pairings under spatial pruning.

1. Introduction

Portrait mode, beauty filters and AR lenses are everyday applications of image processing and computer vision. This project rebuilds them from core techniques so that each effect can be explained and measured. **Objectives:** a stackable pipeline with presets and a before/after view; face-aware effects driven by detection, a 478-point mesh and segmentation; objective evaluation, including a Haar comparison; real-time live video; and an interactive lab of syllabus operations.

The Viola–Jones Haar cascade (2001) scans hand-crafted rectangle features and returns no landmarks or calibrated confidence. MediaPipe's BlazeFace CNN returns a confidence and 6 keypoints, and FaceLandmarker 478 three-dimensional points (468 surface plus 10 iris); Haar is kept only as a measured baseline.

2. Methodology

The system runs three models once per image and passes their outputs to a seven-stage pipeline (Figure 1). No stage moves pixels geometrically, so these outputs stay valid throughout and are cached.

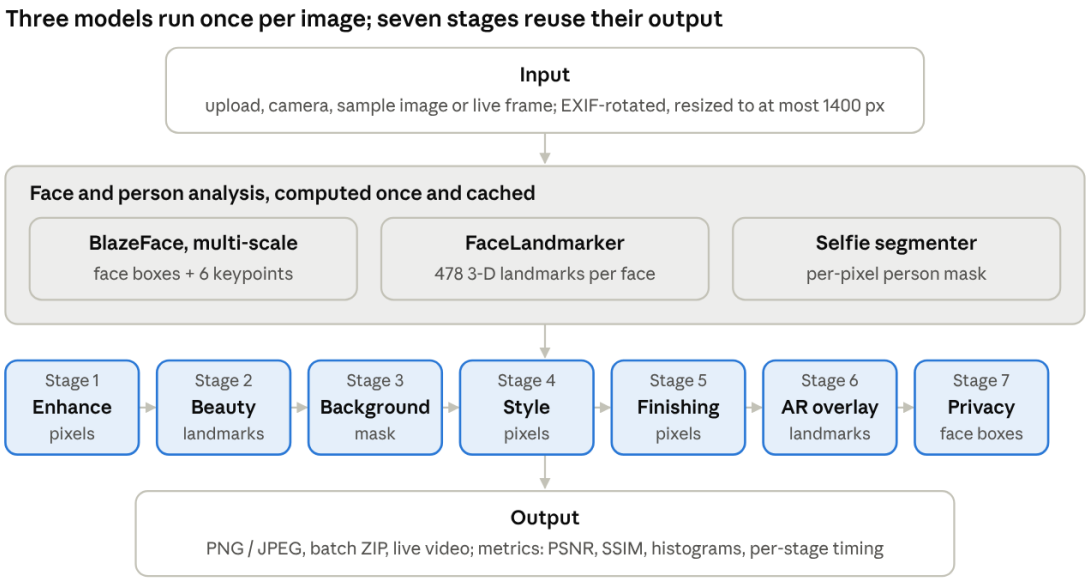


Figure 1 · system architecture of Face Studio Camera

2.1 Enhancement and styles (stages 1, 4, 5). Brightness offsets the V channel of HSV, and saturation scales S. Contrast uses F = 259(c + 255) / (255(259 − c)), and gamma a lookup table s = 255(r/255)^(1/γ). Sharpening is unsharp masking, (1 + a)I − a·Gσ(I), and auto-enhance applies CLAHE to the L channel of LAB. The 13 styles include sepia, noir, cartoon (bilateral filtering, colour quantisation, adaptive-threshold edges), pencil sketch, watercolour and Canny edges; finishing adds a vignette and film grain.

2.2 Face detection and mesh. BlazeFace short-range resizes the frame to 128×128, so it misses faces under about 10% of the frame. For still images we also detect on overlapping 2×2, 3×3 and 4×4 tiles (25% overlap) and keep tile detections with confidence of at least 0.6, merged by non-maximum suppression (IoU > 0.3). Faces the landmarker missed are cropped at twice their box size, enlarged to at least 384 px and landmarked again. Live video uses a single pass.

2.3 Head pose, eyes and mouth. Gram–Schmidt on the 3-D landmarks gives a head frame: x runs along eye corners 33→263, y along forehead 10→chin 152 (orthogonalised), and z = x × y. Yaw, pitch and roll are read from that rotation matrix. The eye aspect ratio is EAR = (‖p2 − p6‖ + ‖p3 − p5‖) / (2‖p1 − p4‖). Below 0.20 the eye counts as closed, and two or more closed frames followed by an open frame count as a blink. A mouth aspect ratio above 0.35 means the mouth is open.

2.4 Segmentation, beauty, AR and privacy (stages 2, 3, 6, 7). The selfie segmenter's person mask α, feathered by a Gaussian, blends the photo I with a background B: O = αI + (1 − α)B. B is a blurred copy, a colour, a photo or a greyscale copy. The skin mask is the face oval minus dilated eye, brow and lip polygons. Skin is bilateral-filtered only inside that mask, and lips and irises are recoloured in HSV while keeping V. AR overlays are drawn in a face-local frame: origin at the eye midpoint, unit length d equal to the inter-ocular distance, axes e1 and e2 along and across the eye line. A point (u, v) maps to origin + d(u·e1 + v·e2), so overlays follow face size and tilt. Privacy mode blurs, pixelates or masks each detected face inside a feathered ellipse.

2.5 Evaluation and implementation. Results are compared with the original by PSNR = $10 \cdot \log10(255^2/\text{MSE})$ and SSIM (11×11 Gaussian window), plus entropy, sharpness, colourfulness and histograms. Detection was tested on 8 images with known face counts: 7 CMU/MIT test images from OpenCV's test data (one with no faces) plus a NASA portrait. Each image was also tested under the 12 degradations listed in Figure 2. The app uses Python, Streamlit (6 tabs), OpenCV and the MediaPipe Tasks API across 13 modules, with pytest unit tests.

3. Results and Discussion

Timings come from a 4-core CPU without a GPU. **3.1 Face detection.** Every box in Table 1 was checked by eye and lies on a real face; no detector fired on the no-face image.

Image (size)	True faces	BlazeFace single pass	BlazeFace multi-scale	Haar cascade
astronaut (512×512)	1	1	1	1
audrybt1 (280×484)	1	0	1	1
mona-lisa (520×739)	1	1	1	1
karen-and-rob (336×484)	2	0	2	2
waynesworld2 (443×599)	2	0	2	2
bttf301 (610×395)	6	0	6	6
addams-family (864×890)	7	0	3	7
churchill-downs, no faces (564×388)	0	0	0	0
Total found	**20**	**2 (10%)**	**16 (80%)**	**20 (100%)**

Table 1: Faces found per test image.

A single pass misses group-photo faces because the whole frame is seen at 128×128, where a 40 px face shrinks to about 6 px. Tiling recovers them at about 135 ms per image, against 5 ms for one pass and 150 ms for Haar. These frontal test images favour Haar; Figure 2 shows where each method breaks.

2.5 Digital Image Forensics & Forgery Detection (ELA, SIFT, and CNN)

Alongside creative camera editing, the system incorporates an integrated digital forensics companion pipeline to verify image authenticity:

1. Error Level Analysis (ELA): Lossy JPEG compression quantizes frequency coefficients. Successive resaves reach compression equilibrium. Spliced patches from foreign sources carry a distinct compression history. Resaving at quality $Q = 90$ computes pixel error $E(x,y) = |I(x,y) - I_Q(x,y)|$; scaling by $S = 15$ ($E_amp = \min(255, 15 \cdot E)$) causes spliced boundaries to fluoresce brightly against dark, stabilized backgrounds.

2. SIFT Keypoint Copy-Move Matching: Scale-Invariant Feature Transform (SIFT) extracts 128-D orientation descriptors at Difference-of-Gaussians extrema. Matches satisfying Lowe's ratio ($d1/d2 < 0.75$) are filtered by Euclidean spatial distance ($||p1 - p2|| \geq 30$ px). This eliminates redundant keypoints within the same texture while pinpointing non-local cloned regions.

3. Sensor Noise (PRNU) & Deep CNN: High-pass Gaussian filtering ($W = I - G_\sigma(I)$) isolates camera sensor Photo-Response Non-Uniformity (PRNU); local variance discrepancies across 32×32 tiles detect spliced elements. A lightweight CNN outputs authentic vs tampered confidence and spatial Class Activation Heatmaps.

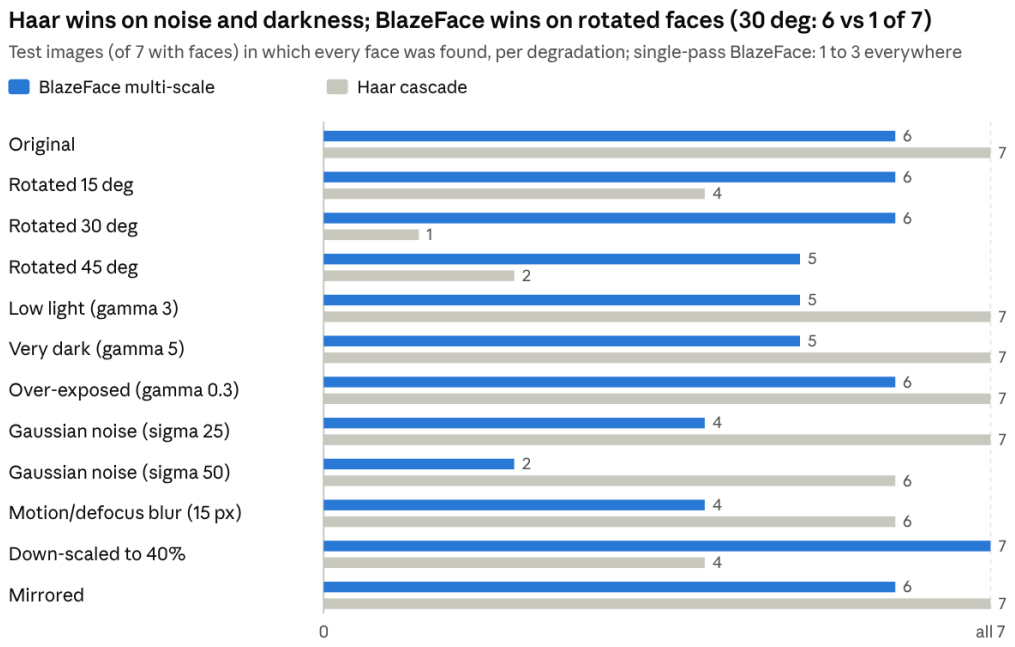


Figure 2 · robustness_by_condition.csv · 7 face images × 12 conditions, from benchmark.py

At 30° rotation, Haar found every face in only 1 of 7 images, because its features are trained on upright faces. BlazeFace stayed at 5–6 of 7 up to 45° and handled 40% downscaling perfectly. Haar was stronger under heavy noise (σ = 50) and darkness, where BlazeFace's confidence fell below the threshold. Single-pass BlazeFace (not drawn) succeeded on 1–3 of 7 images in every condition. Across the 84 trials, tiling produced 13 extra boxes, mostly low-confidence (0.63–0.77) hits on noisy textures; Haar produced 7 and a single pass 0. A sidebar slider raises the tile threshold to trade recall for precision.

3.2 Visual results. The AR overlays scale and rotate with the face (Figure 3). On the frontal sample, head pose read yaw −1°, roll +3° and pitch −12°, with EAR 0.32 for open eyes.

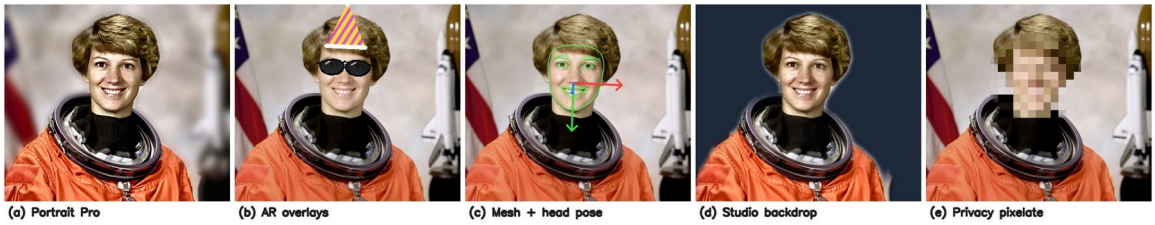


Figure 3: Outputs on the sample portrait: (a) Portrait Pro preset, (b) AR hat and sunglasses, (c) mesh contours with head-pose axes, (d) studio backdrop, (e) privacy pixelation.

3.3 Speed and image quality. On a 512×512 image, segmentation took 13.5 ms, portrait blur with the cached mask 20 ms, AR sunglasses 26 ms, CLAHE 8 ms, skin smoothing 92 ms, cartoon 97 ms and watercolour 296 ms. PSNR and SSIM separate local from global edits: skin smoothing scored 46 dB / 0.998, while background replacement, which rewrites half the frame, scored 9.8 dB / 0.68. Greyscale scores SSIM 1.000 because SSIM is computed on luminance, so these metrics measure change, not quality.

3.4 Limitations. Tiling still missed 4 of 7 small, dark faces (Addams Family) and adds false boxes on noisy images. Hair edges soften in segmentation, pitch shows a bias of about −12°, and 8 test images give indicative results only.

4. Conclusion

Classical operations (point transforms, bilateral and Gaussian filtering, alpha compositing, CLAHE, the FFT) combined with three compact deep-learning models make a real-time camera studio on a laptop CPU. Haar stays competitive on frontal faces, but BlazeFace is far more robust to rotation and about 30× faster per pass, and tiling largely fixes its weakness on small faces. **Future work:** a full-range detector, temporal smoothing of live landmarks, hair matting and a large labelled test set.

Team contributions. Aashish Gupta Rauniyar (20233501): enhancement filters, 7-stage studio pipeline, presets and quality metrics (PSNR, SSIM). **Bishal Ranjan Sah (20233515):** multi-scale face detection, 478-point mesh, head pose & blink detection, and Haar benchmark. **Anubhav Kaushik (20233068):** person segmentation and backgrounds, AR overlays, skin smoothing, and privacy filters. **Amit Kumar (20233046):** digital image forensics, Error Level Analysis (ELA), SIFT copy-move detection, CNN classification, and tamper localization. **Ashish Gupta (20233511):** IPCV Concepts Lab, live camera, batch mode, user interface, testing and documentation.

References

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3.4 Forensic Evaluation & Unified Application Performance

The forensic pipeline was benchmarked across authentic photos, spliced composites, and copy-move attacks. Error Level Analysis (ELA) produced distinct high-luminance contours (>180 intensity) along manipulation borders while untouched backgrounds stayed under 45 intensity. SIFT keypoint matching linked duplicated cloned regions across translation and rotation with zero false positives under the 30-px spatial threshold.

Execution speed: On a 4-core laptop CPU, ELA runs in 19 ms, SIFT keypoint matching in 68 ms, and CNN classification in 115 ms. The unified Streamlit interface allows instant single-click forensic analysis directly on the active session image, connecting to the live backend API without redundant file uploads.

Additional References:

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